

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

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Last week: **DJIA** 49499.27 ▲ 268.56 0.55% **NASDAQ** 25114.44 ▲ 1.1% **STOXX 600** 611.55 ▲ 0.1% **10-YR. TREASURY** ▼ 17/32, yield 4.377% **OIL** \$101.94 ▲ \$7.54 **EURO** \$1.1723 **YEN** 157.07

What's News

Business & Finance

- ◆ **Investors feared** that the Iran war energy shock would derail a big year for international stocks, but the MSCI Emerging Markets Index rebounded to new highs quicker than the S&P 500. **B1**
- ◆ **Many of the world's** major economies have been soldiering on in contrast with the swift downturns that accompanied similar energy crises in the 1970s and 1990s. **A1**
- ◆ **GameStop is making** an unsolicited offer to buy eBay for \$56 billion, seeing a path to make the ecommerce company a much bigger competitor to Amazon. **A1**
- ◆ **U.S. foreclosure filings hit** a six-year high in the first quarter, and fast-rising property-tax and insurance bills are a reason to blame. **A2**
- ◆ **Berkshire Hathaway's** new CEO said the company, which is sitting on a growing pile of cash, has a shortlist of companies it is interested in buying. **B1**
- ◆ **Anthropic plans** a joint venture including Blackstone and Goldman Sachs to sell AI tools to private-equity-backed companies. **B1**
- ◆ **The new head of** Trump Media & Technology Group faces the challenge of figuring out how to package its odd mix of ventures. **B1**
- ◆ **The actors union** has reached a tentative deal with the major studios and streamers on a new contract. **B3**
- ◆ **"The Devil Wears Prada 2"** earned \$233.6 million worldwide in its opening weekend. **B3**

Worldwide

- ◆ **President Trump** said the U.S. would start guiding commercial ships out of the Strait of Hormuz where they have been trapped by the war. Officials said Navy warships won't be used as escorts. **A1**
- ◆ **A string of cities** across America's Sunbelt are emerging as graduate-hiring hot spots in an otherwise challenging job market for young professionals. **A1**
- ◆ **The number of** food-stamp recipients has decreased by nearly 3.5 million nationwide as states move to implement new Trump administration rules on who qualifies for the program. **A3**
- ◆ **Despite Iowa's history** as a Republican stronghold, non-partisan analysts rate the state's race for governor and two of its four U.S. House contests as tossups. **A4**
- ◆ **U.S. attorney** for the District of Columbia Jeanine Pirro said a Secret Service agent was hit by buckshot from the gun of the alleged attacker during the attempt to kill Trump last month. **A6**
- ◆ **OPEC sought to project** a united front, agreeing to a symbolic increase in oil output just days after the U.A.E.'s departure. **A8**
- ◆ **Mexico's governor** of Sinaloa will temporarily step down after the U.S. charged him with drug-trafficking. **A10**
- ◆ **American and allied** military forces are searching for two U.S. Army soldiers who went missing in Morocco during a training exercise. **A10**

JOURNAL REPORT
Investing Monthly:
The five documents
your estate plan
needs. **B7-8**

CONTENTS	Opinion..... A15-17
Arts in Review..... A14	Personal Journal A12-13
Business & Finance B2-3	Sports..... A18
Crossword..... A13	Technology..... B4
Heard on Street... B12	Ticker..... B12
Journal Report... B7-8	U.S. News..... A2-6
Market Data..... B9	World News..... A8-11



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For One Day, All of New York City Is a Bike Path



ROLL PLAYERS: More than 30,000 cyclists on Sunday rode through Brooklyn during the annual TD Five Boro Bike Tour.

Global Economy Powers Ahead Despite Growing Energy Shock

Full oil inventories, advances in energy efficiency, AI boom help put off a slump

By JASON DOUGLAS

One of the major surprises about the gravest energy shock since the 1970s is how resilient much of the world has been.

The closure of the Strait of Hormuz has yanked around 13 million barrels of oil a day from global energy supplies.

Blackouts have hit Pakistan, the Philippines has imposed a four-day workweek, and countries including Slovenia and Bangladesh have rationed fuel. The risk that the world sinks into recession is rising with each day the waterway remains shut. The price of Brent crude, the global oil benchmark, has risen more than 50% since the strait was closed.

Even so, in the two months since the strait was closed by Iran in response to U.S. and Israeli attacks, many of the world's major economies have

been soldiering on in contrast to the swift downturns that accompanied similar energy crises in the 1970s and 1990s. Stock markets are touching records.

This resilience reflects ample energy reserves, policies to help consumers, and the offsetting effects of the artificial-intelligence boom that is powering trade and business investment in the U.S. and beyond.

It also highlights an underappreciated shift in the workings of the global economy. Over the years, countries have

become steadily more energy efficient, squeezing more economic activity out of each drop of oil or cubic meter of natural gas burned.

The energy needed to generate a dollar of gross domestic product, adjusted for inflation, has since 2000 fallen by about a third in the U.S. and Europe and by about 40% in China, according to World

- ◆ **OPEC signals unity** after U.A.E. pulls out..... **A8**
- ◆ **Map with tanker data** takes center stage..... **A8**

College Grads Find Sunbelt Hot Job Spot

By RAY A. SMITH

A string of cities across the U.S. Sunbelt are emerging as graduate-hiring hot spots in an otherwise challenging job market for young professionals, an exclusive analysis shows.

Birmingham, Ala., tops the overall list of the places where newly minted graduates are landing jobs with a college-level career track, followed by Tampa, Fla., according to the new study by the payroll processor ADP.

In fact, six of the list's top 10—including Raleigh, N.C.;

Tulsa, Okla.; Nashville, Tenn.; and Charlotte, N.C.—are in the South.

Other pockets of the country also punch above their weight as early career launchpads for their mix of 20-something hiring, pay and affordability. Columbus, Ohio, and California's San Jose area unexpectedly got top scores this year—evidence that even places with so-so earning potential or high costs of living can be prime locations for landing that first job post-graduation.

Altogether, the ADP analysis

Please turn to page A2

Troop Exit Is Least Of Europe's Issues

By BERTRAND BENOIT
AND DANIEL MICHAELS

BERLIN—German officials shrugged off President Trump's decision to withdraw 5,000 U.S. troops from the country as symbolic, but some analysts warned the trans-Atlantic rift risks leaving Europe's economy and security dangerously exposed.

Trump's latest increase in tariffs on European cars, his apparent U-turn on plans to station long-range missiles in Germany and the economic and military fallout from the war in Iran will have a bigger effect on the region, they warned.

"All of these are a bigger deal than a symbolic 5K-troop reduction," said Thorsten Benner, director of the Global Public Policy Institute, a Berlin security think tank. "So is the rapid depletion of U.S. arsenals due to wasting enormous amounts of precious assets in the Iran war."

Senior U.S. defense officials on Friday said the Pentagon would withdraw an army brigade from Germany within six to 12 months, days after German Chancellor Friedrich Merz said the U.S. didn't seem to have an exit strategy in Iran

Please turn to page A10

A Whistler On a Mission To Be a Star

* * *
Dry mouth and
blank stares won't
stop Chris Ullman

By BECKY YERAK

Chris Ullman knows he's a polarizing figure in entertainment.

The 62-year-old has performed for a U.S. president, on the "Tonight Show" and at a recent Baltimore Orioles game.

He has also been met with blank stares and awkward silences, and once got turned down by a high-school band.

Those are the occupational hazards of a professional whistler. Some people love the sound of songs blown through puckered lips, or at least appreciate the effort. Others find it freaky and annoying.

"You rarely find someone

Please turn to page A13

ChatGPT Wrestles With Grisly Queries

Chatbot's advice on weapons and mass shootings puts OpenAI under scrutiny

By GEORGIA WELLS

Last spring, Florida State University student Phoenix Ikner wanted to know how many classmates he needed to kill to become notorious.

ChatGPT responded with a metric. "Usually 3 or more dead, 5-6 total victims, pushes it onto national media," the AI service told Ikner, who had spent the previous night describing to the chatbot how he was feeling depressed and suicidal, according to a transcript of the exchanges reviewed by The Wall Street Journal.

Then Ikner uploaded an image of a Glock handgun and ammunition and asked the chatbot how to use it. Was there a safety to switch off? ChatGPT told him there wasn't: "If there's a round in

the chamber and you pull the trigger? It will fire."

Ikner logged off. Four minutes later, prosecutors say, he killed two people and injured six at Florida State. Ikner faces charges of murder and attempted murder. He has pleaded not guilty.

Ikner's case is one of at least two known instances in just over a year in which mass shooting suspects have turned to AI chatbots as confidants to discuss violent scenarios or as sounding boards to plan attacks. The carnage is sparking lawsuits, government and law enforcement investigations and internal debate inside AI companies over a question Silicon Valley is struggling to answer: When a chatbot appears to be helping plan violence,

Please turn to page A11

U.S. Will Attempt To Guide Ships Out Of Strait

Trump plan doesn't involve Navy escorts; Iran warns effort would violate truce

By LARA SELIGMAN
AND ROBBIE GRAMER

President Trump said Sunday the U.S. would start guiding commercial ships out of the Strait of Hormuz where they have been trapped by the war between the U.S. and Iran, in an arm's-length effort to unblock the vital supply route.

The new mechanism is effectively a coordination cell to move traffic through the strait, involving countries, insurance companies and shipping organizations, according to two senior U.S. officials. It doesn't currently involve U.S. Navy warships escorting vessels through the strait, the officials said.

But European diplomats and shipowners recalled previous failed attempts by the president to get shipping moving, including his call for North Atlantic Treaty Organization allies to send warships, a request that went unheeded. Without warship escorts, a coordination cell is unlikely to markedly

Please turn to page A8

GameStop Bids to Buy eBay for \$56 Billion

By LAUREN THOMAS

GameStop Chief Executive Ryan Cohen made an unsolicited offer to buy **eBay** for about \$56 billion and said he saw a path to make the e-commerce company a much bigger competitor to **Amazon.com**.

Cohen told The Wall Street Journal on Sunday that GameStop has built a roughly 5% stake in eBay and was offering \$125 a share in cash and stock, a roughly 20% premium to its closing price on Friday.

"eBay should be worth—and will be worth—a lot more money," Cohen said in an interview. "I'm thinking about turning eBay into something worth hundreds of billions of dollars."

Cohen said GameStop has a commitment letter from TD Bank to provide around \$20 billion in debt financing to help make a deal possible.

Please turn to page A6

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